

DECENT COACHING CLASSES

Grammar Session 7

Degree of Comparison & Transformation of Sentences

Class 8 • Class 9 • Class 10 | Maharashtra State Board & CBSE

10th August

Agenda

Transformation

A

Degree of Comparison

Positive, Comparative & Superlative — formation rules, irregulars & the words that can't be compared

B

Interchange of Degrees

Rewriting one degree as another without changing the meaning

C

Interrogative → Assertive

Turning rhetorical questions into plain statements, and back

D

Affirmative → Exclamatory

How.../What a...! → very/extremely

E

Affirmative → Negative

only, every, everybody — the standard interchange patterns

F

Simple → Compound → Complex

Expanding phrases into clauses, and reducing clauses into phrases

G

Too...to → So...that

The most-tested transformation pattern in board exams

Quick Recap — Session 6

You already know these building blocks. We'll lean on them heavily today.

Sentence structure

Simple = 1 clause. Compound = 2+ independent clauses joined by FANBOYS. Complex = 1 main clause + 1 or more subordinate clauses.

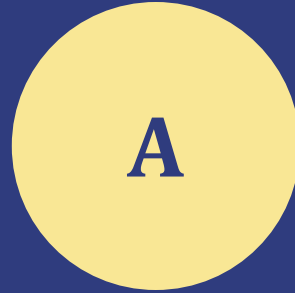
Clauses

A clause has a subject + finite verb. Independent clauses make sense alone; dependent (noun/adjective/adverb) clauses don't.

Conjunctions

Coordinating (FANBOYS) join equals. Subordinating (because, although, if, when...) introduce dependent clauses.

Today, the number of clauses in a sentence is exactly what changes when we transform it — keep that idea in mind throughout.



PART A

Degree of Comparison

How English shows that one thing is more, most, or just as much as another

What Is Degree of Comparison?

Degrees of Comparison are the forms an adjective or adverb takes when we compare one person, place, or thing with another.

Positive

Simply describes — no comparison at all.

Sana is tall.

Comparative

Compares exactly TWO people/things. Uses 'than'.

Sana is taller than Zoya.

Superlative

Compares THREE or more. Uses 'the'.

Sana is the tallest in her class.

Formation Rules — Regular Adjectives (1 of 3)

RULE 1 — Words ending in 'e'

Just add 'r' for comparative and 'st' for superlative.

Positive	Comparative	Superlative
safe	safer	safest
wide	wider	widest
tame	tamer	tamest
brave	braver	bravest

RULE 2 — Words ending in 'y' (after a consonant)

Change 'y' to 'i' then add 'er' / 'est'.

Positive	Comparative	Superlative
tidy	tidier	tidiest
happy	happier	happiest
lucky	luckier	luckiest
easy	easier	easiest

Just for fun 'Happy' doesn't stay happy — the 'y' turns into an 'i' before it can be happier!

Formation Rules — Regular Adjectives (2 of 3)

RULE 3 — Short vowel + single consonant

One-syllable word with a short vowel sound ending in a single consonant: double the last letter, then add 'er'/'est'.

Positive	Comparative	Superlative
<u>big</u>	bigger	biggest
hot	hot <u>ter</u>	hottest
sad	sadder	saddest
thin	thinner	thinnest

RULE 4 — One syllable ending in two consonants

Just add 'er' / 'est' — no doubling needed.

Positive	Comparative	Superlative
smart <u>er</u>	smarter	smartest
black <u>er</u>	blacker	blackest
cold	colder	coldest
strong	stronger	strongest

Exam tip: Check THREE things before doubling — one syllable, short vowel sound, AND single consonant at the end. 'wet' → 'wetter' doubles; 'cold' does not (two consonants already).

Formation Rules — Regular Adjectives (3 of 3)

RULE 5 — Three or more syllables

Place 'more' before the word for comparative and 'most' for superlative. Never add '-er'/'-est' to these words.

Positive	Comparative	Superlative
<u>beautiful</u>	more <u>beautiful</u>	<u>most</u> beautiful
<u>interesting</u>	more interesting	most interesting
expensive	more expensive	most expensive
dangerous	more dangerous	most dangerous

RULE 6 — Two-syllable words (both forms exist)

Some 2-syllable words — especially ending in -er, -y, -le, -ow, -et — can take either -er/-est OR more/most. Both are accepted; pick one style and stay consistent.

cleverer

Positive	Option 1	Option 2
<u>clever</u>	<u>cleverer</u>	<u>more clever</u>
simple	<u>simpler</u>	<u>more simple</u>
quiet	<u>quieter</u>	<u>more quiet</u>

Just for fun ~~'Beautifuler'~~ isn't a word — it just sounds like your tongue tripped over a speed bump!

Irregular Comparisons — Learn These by Heart

These do not follow any spelling rule — the words change completely.

Positive	Comparative	Superlative	Positive	Comparative	Superlative
good / well	better	best	old (age, general)	older	oldest
bad / ill	worse	worst	old (family relation)	elder	eldest
much / many	more	most	late (time)	later	latest
little (quantity)	less	least	late (order/rank)	latter	last
far (distance)	farther	farthest	near (distance)	nearer	nearest
far (degree)	further	furthest	near (order)	nearer	next

Adjectives That Cannot Be Compared

Absolute adjectives already describe a complete, all-or-nothing state. Since nothing can be 'more' complete than complete, these words are not usually given comparative or superlative forms in formal exam writing.

unique

perfect

complete

full

empty

round

square

dead

infinite

eternal

correct

final

Exam note: You may still see 'more unique' or 'most perfect' in casual speech for emphasis, but board answer keys mark the plain positive form as correct.

Master Table — Formation Rules at a Glance

MASTER TABLE — Revision Anchor

Rule	Applies to	Comparative	Superlative	Example
1	Ends in ‘e’	+ r	+ st	safe → safer → safest
2	Ends in ‘y’	y→i + er	y→i + est	happy → happier → happiest
3	1 syll., short vowel + 1 consonant	double + er	double + est	big → bigger → biggest
4	1 syllable, 2 consonants	+ er	+ est	cold → colder → coldest
5	3+ syllables	more +	most +	beautiful → more/most beautiful
6	Irregular	changes fully	changes fully	good → better → best

J is the biggest planet

Interchange of Degrees — The Three Patterns

Riya is a girl

The SAME comparison can always be written in all three degrees without changing its meaning.

Positive

No other + Noun + is + as/so + Adj + as + Noun.

Comparative

Noun + is + more/-er + Adj + than + any other + Noun.

Superlative

Noun + is + the most/-est + Adj + of all + Noun (plural).

Worked triangle: "No other planet is as big as Jupiter" (Positive) = "Jupiter is bigger than any other planet" (Comparative) = "Jupiter is the biggest of all planets" (Superlative).

Interchange — Worked Examples

Given (Comparative): Helen was more beautiful than any other woman.

Positive: No other woman was as beautiful as Helen. **Superlative:** Helen was the most beautiful of all women.

Given (Comparative): The airplane flies faster than birds.

Positive: Birds do not fly as fast as the airplane. **Superlative:** The airplane is the fastest of all (flying things compared).

Given (Positive): Very few Indian cities are as big as Hyderabad.

Comparative: Hyderabad is bigger than most other Indian cities. **Superlative:** Hyderabad is one of the biggest of Indian cities.

Given (Comparative): Akbar was greater than most other Indian kings.

Positive: Very few Indian kings were as great as Akbar. **Superlative:** Akbar was one of the greatest of Indian kings.

Previous Year Questions (1 of 2)

Q1

8th SB

Best

Fill in with the correct degree: This is the ____ (good) film I have seen this year.

Q2

8th CBSE

Change the degree without changing the meaning: Iron is more useful than any other metal.

P - No other metal is as useful as iron
S - Iron is the most useful metal of all

Q3

9th CBSE

more

Choose the correct form: She is ____ (careful) than her sister.

~~carefuller~~

Q4

10th SB

Rewrite in the comparative degree. Delhi is one of the most crowded cities in India.

Delhi is more crowded than most of the other cities in India

Previous Year Questions (2 of 2)

Q1

8th SB

Give the comparative and superlative of little (quantity) and far (distance).

less least

*farther
farthest*

Q2

8th CBSE

Identify the error: My elder brother is ~~more~~ taller than me.

Q3

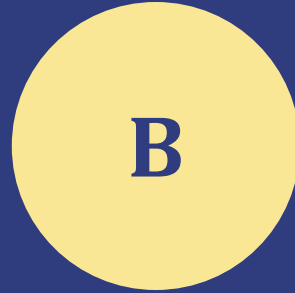
9th CBSE

Rewrite using the superlative degree: Very few boys in the class are as intelligent as Rohan.

Q4

10th SB

Which word CANNOT normally take a comparative form, and why? unique / tall / helpful



PART B

Transformation Patterns

Rewriting a sentence in a different form without changing its meaning

Interrogative → Assertive (Rhetorical Questions)

A **rhetorical question** is one that is not really asking for information — it makes a statement in question form. It can always be rewritten as a plain assertive (statement) sentence.

RULE — Question begins with a Wh-word

‘Who’ → nobody / everybody. ‘What’ → nothing. ‘Why’ → there is no reason.
Drop the question mark; reverse polarity.

RULE — Yes/No question (helping verb first)

Move the helping verb after the subject and remove the question mark; keep or add ‘not’ as needed to reverse the sense.

Q: Who does not know that the earth is round? → A: Everybody knows that the earth is round.

Q: What is the use of crying over spilt milk? → A: It is of no use crying over spilt milk.

Q: Isn't it a beautiful morning? → A: It is a beautiful morning.

Q: Why should I help him? → A: I have no reason to help him.

Affirmative → Exclamatory

Exclamatory → Affirmative

Drop 'How' / 'What (a/an)' and the exclamation mark. Insert 'very', 'really', or 'extremely' before the adjective and complete the sentence as a statement.

Affirmative → Exclamatory

Pull the adjective to the front after 'How' (for adjectives/adverbs alone) or 'What a/an' (for a noun phrase), and end with '!'.

Excl: How beautiful this garden is! **Aff:** This garden is very beautiful.

Excl: How nice Dhoni played! **Aff:** Dhoni played really nicely.

Excl: What a tasty ice-cream! **Aff:** This ice-cream is extremely tasty.

Excl: What a hot day it is! **Aff:** It is a very hot day.

Excl: How fast she runs! **Aff:** She runs really fast.

Affirmative → Negative

Every affirmative (positive) sentence has an equivalent negative sentence carrying the exact same meaning.

only X → none but X

Only a millionaire can afford such luxuries. → None but a millionaire can afford such luxuries.

None

everybody / all → nobody... not / there is no one who does not

Everybody was present. → Nobody was absent.

every + noun → there is no + noun + who/that does not

Every man makes mistakes sometimes. → There is no man who does not make mistakes sometimes.

Verb (fact stated plainly) → did not fail to / was not without

Brutus loved Caesar. → Brutus was not without love for Caesar.

always / certainly → never fails to / cannot but

He always helps the poor. → He never fails to help the poor.

Conversion — Simple → Compound

How to convert

Split the simple sentence's phrase into a second independent clause, and join both clauses with a coordinating conjunction (and, but, or, so, yet). Going the other way: merge the two clauses back into one, turning the second clause into a participle phrase.

Simple: He must work very hard to make up for the lost time.

Compound: He must work very hard and make up for the lost time.

Simple: In spite of his hard work, he did not succeed.

Compound: He worked hard yet he did not succeed.

Simple: Little Jay sat in a corner, eating his Christmas cake.

Compound: Little Jay sat in a corner and ate his Christmas cake.

Simple: He must resign on pain of public dismissal.

Compound: He must resign, or he will be publicly dismissed.

Simple: Owing to the drought, the crop is short.

Compound: There is a drought, and so the crop is short.

Conversion — Simple → Complex

How to convert

Expand a phrase in the simple sentence into a subordinate (dependent) clause introduced by that, if, as, while, because, where, etc. Going the other way: reduce the subordinate clause back into a phrase.

Simple: He confessed his crime.

Complex: He confessed that he was guilty.

Simple: Only Pakistanis are admitted here.

Complex: If you are not a Pakistani, you cannot be admitted here.

Simple: The management is thoroughly bad.

Complex: The management is as bad as it could possibly be.

Simple: The prince was to be found in the hottest battle.

Complex: The prince was to be found where the battle was the hottest.

Simple: Not feeling well, he decided to lie down.

Complex: As he was not feeling well, he decided to lie down.

+ , -

'Too...to' → 'So...that' — The Board-Favourite Pattern

Formula: Subject + is/was + too + adjective + to + verb ↔ Subject + is/was + so + adjective + that + subject (pronoun) + cannot/could not + verb

Too...to: My friend is too rich to be helped. **So...that:** My friend is so rich that he cannot be helped.

Too...to: He is too proud to beg. **So...that:** He is so proud that he will not beg.

Too...to: It is never too late to mend. **So...that:** It is never so late that it cannot be mended.

Too...to: He is too ignorant for the post of a postman. **So...that:** He is so ignorant that he is not suitable for the post of a postman.

Too...to: This shirt is too small for me. **So...that:** This shirt is so small that it is not suitable for me.

Too...to: He speaks too fast to be understood. **So...that:** He speaks so fast that he cannot be understood.

Master Table — All Interchange Patterns

MASTER TABLE — Revision Anchor

Interchange	Key marker word(s)	Direction of change
Positive ↔ Comparative ↔ Superlative	as...as / than / the most/-est	Degree of the adjective changes
Interrogative ↔ Assertive	Wh-word / helping verb first	Question mark removed; polarity reversed
Affirmative ↔ Exclamatory	How.../What a...!	Adjective/noun moved to front; '!' added or removed
Affirmative ↔ Negative	only, every, everybody, always	Positive marker ↔ negative marker (not, no, none, never)
Simple ↔ Compound	and, but, or, so, yet	Phrase becomes a 2nd independent clause
Simple ↔ Complex	that, if, as, because, where	Phrase becomes a subordinate clause
Too...to ↔ So...that	too / so...that	Infinitive clause ↔ result clause with can't/couldn't

Previous Year Questions (1 of 2)

Q1

8th SB

Rewrite using so...that: The tea is too hot to drink.

The tea is so hot that it cannot be drunk

Q2

8th CBSE

Turn into an assertive sentence: How beautifully she sings! *very*

Q3

9th CBSE

Change into a negative sentence without changing the meaning: Every student passed the exam.

None of the students failed the exam

Q4

10th SB

Convert into a complex sentence: In spite of trying hard, he failed.

He tried hard yet —

Previous Year Questions (2 of 2)

Q1

correlative conjunction

8th SB

Convert into a compound sentence: Being tired, she went to sleep early.

She was so tired that

Q2

8th CBSE

Turn into an interrogative (rhetorical) sentence: Nobody can deny that honesty is the best policy.

— Isn't honesty the best policy?

Q3

9th CBSE

Rewrite using 'too...to': He is so weak that he cannot walk.

He is too weak
to talk

Q4

10th SB

E - A

Identify the transformation type and rewrite: What a shame it is!

It is such a shame

Session 7 Recap



Degree of Comparison

3 degrees, 6 formation rules, irregular forms, and words that resist comparison altogether.



Interchange of Degrees

Positive → Comparative → Superlative — same meaning, different form.



Interrogative → Assertive

Rhetorical questions restate as plain facts, and back again.



Affirmative → Exclamatory

How.../What a...! swaps places with very/extremely.



Affirmative → Negative

only/every/everybody flip to none but/no one who doesn't/nobody.



Simple → Compound → Complex

Phrases expand into clauses — and clauses reduce back into phrases.



Too...to → So...that

The single most frequently tested transformation pattern.

love
Sankshita Riddhi loves to study F V
Shambhavi Riddhi loves sleeping NFV

THANK YOU

Practice the worksheet — next session builds directly on today's patterns.